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- if you think you may have a problem.
20. If there is a competitive market for health-care services (e.g., more than one maternity hospital in your town), negotiate prices, preferably before you receive services.
 21. Check out the safety, effectiveness, and clinical soundness of home remedies, herbs, and supplements at PeoplesPharmacy.com and Consumer Reports-Health (ConsumerReports.org/Health/Natural-Health.htm).
 22. Evaluate hospitals using The Leapfrog Group's ratings (LeapfrogGroup.org).
 23. Donate blood and receive free blood pressure, iron-level, and temperature checks.
 24. Establish a relationship with a primary care physician through an "establish visit."
 25. Get better, more informed, and quicker medical advice by preparing a written summary of your medical history (should include surgeries, medical conditions, medications, allergies, family history, and social history).
 26. Communicate priorities during the initial part of the physician visit, rather than waiting until the very end of the visit to express your concerns about an important matter.
 27. Help your physician arrive at a diagnosis with a minimum of tests by discussing your symptoms in terms of *when* you first noticed the problem and *when* it occurs; *what* it feels like (sharp or dull, constant or intermittent) and *what* seems to make the problem better or worse; *where* in the body it occurs; and *why* you are concerned.
 28. Make sure you understand any diagnosis, additional testing requirements, treatment plan, and further assessments recommended by your physician before you leave the office.
 29. Before allowing medical treatment (giving informed consent), determine the benefits, risks or complications, and alternatives to treatment plans.
 30. Don't hesitate to get a second opinion not only on the diagnosis but also for the treatment plan if you feel uncomfortable with your physician's plan, and especially if you have a rare disease.
 31. If you are waiting on test results, never accept the phrase, "We'll only contact you if the results are bad." Ask for a callback or, preferably, written documentation of your test results.
 32. Get immunizations to prevent certain diseases.
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